The size of environmental services was estimated to be about $20 billion in 2017.

Services delivered through the presence of persons abroad form a relatively minor part of the total export of services, totalling only $0.4 trillion in 2017.

Construction services are estimated to have grown at 7 per cent annually since 2005, with China emerging as a major construction services exporter ($188 billion in 2017 accounting for over 37 per cent of construction exports).

The three services that recorded an annual growth rate higher than 10 per cent since 2017 included research and development (R & D) services and health services, though with a smaller base.

India does not have any significant presence in these areas.

Services Exports More Concentrated in Developed and a Few Developing Countries than Goods Exports

While developed countries have ceded manufacturing to developing countries since the 1980s, they have monopolized the export of services. In 2005, developed countries had a share of over 85 per cent in global export of services. That said, developing countries gained a notable share of over 10 per cent from 2005 to 2017; this grew to over 25 per cent in 2017. Among the developing economies, five countries, all from Asia (China, Korea, Hong Kong, Singapore and India), accounted for over half (56.7 per cent) of the developing countries' export of services. Their share of global export was 14.5 per cent whereas the rest of the 125 developing countries could manage to export 10.7 per cent.

These five developing countries are expanding services export in construction; financial, professional, business and distribution services; and ICT and transport by establishing a commercial presence abroad. However,